

Megan R. Lancaster

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ABOUT ME

PMP®-certified project manager and senior learning experience designer with more than a decade of experience leading instructional design, educational technology, and faculty-support initiatives in higher education. Skilled at turning complex ideas into practical, scalable solutions and creating the processes, templates, and resources that help teams work with clarity and autonomy. Known as an approachable mentor and collaborative partner who builds trust, supports change, and helps faculty and cross-functional teams meet evolving needs. Experienced in navigating emerging technologies, including the responsible application of AI to teaching, learning, and institutional workflows.

SKILLS

Learning design:

Universal Design for Learning (UDL), ADA and WCAG/Section 508 accessibility compliance, learning strategy, adult learning theory, design thinking, evaluation and learner feedback (Qualtrics), quality assurance rubrics (Quality Matters, OLC), content creation and graphic/media design (Camtasia, Adobe Creative Cloud)

Project and program management:

Project and portfolio management (waterfall, hybrid, and Agile), project scoping, stakeholder engagement, cross-functional collaboration, coaching and mentoring, project tracking (Monday.com)

Learning technologies:

Canvas (for-credit), Coursera (professional, non-credit)

AI and data-informed practice:

AI-assisted workflows (Claude Code, Claude Skills), data-driven decision-making

EXPERIENCE

DUKE UNIVERSITY | Durham, NC (Remote)

Senior Learning Experience Designer and Project Manager

April 2021 – Present

- Co-designed Coursera's integrated labs interface, a UDL-aligned innovation deployed platform-wide, reducing cognitive load in technical courses well beyond Duke's own offerings.
- Designed, built, and launched an internal AI tooling suite for the learning design team: a Coursera Interaction Generator (built with Claude Code) for custom quiz, drag-and-drop, and annotation interactions, and a library of Claude Skills standardizing the team's intake, scoping, and course design workflows.
- Launched 50+ online courses and specializations across for-credit (Canvas) and professional, non-credit (Coursera) programs at Duke's engineering, nursing, data science, and corporate education units, upholding accessibility standards and evidence-based pedagogical design for online learning.
- Co-developed the team's course quality assurance system, integrating Quality Matters and OLC rubrics with Duke-specific standards into a consistent framework for course review and continuous improvement.

- Built a Project Scoping Framework that identifies the true needs of a prospective project, defines scope and guardrails, and sets timelines around faculty availability; currently applying it to lead scoping for a Systems Engineering online master's program and a Digital Assets specialization, and to support scoping for an OCS-Climate specialization.
- Lead cross-functional project teams (e.g., faculty, media designers, and learning experience designers) to meet scope timelines and delivery milestones, applying waterfall, hybrid, and Agile approaches as needed; introduced Agile sprint practices within the team to strengthen delivery consistency and build design capacity.
- Created a self-guided Coursera development pathway adopted by 25+ faculty, doubling course output while maintaining quality standards.
- Mentored colleagues and advised leadership on faculty autonomy models and alternative credentialing strategies.

Learning Experience Designer

January 2020 – April 2021

- Led design sprints with faculty across Duke University and Duke Health, translating complex subject matter into high-impact online and hybrid learning experiences.
- Developed interactive prototypes and assessments, then iterated using learner analytics and faculty feedback to improve engagement and demonstrate learning outcomes.

HIGH POINT UNIVERSITY | High Point, NC

Educational Technology Specialist

July 2018 – December 2019

- Led campus-wide rollout of instructional technology and Blackboard LMS for 100+ faculty; created the Blackboard Bootcamp training pipeline, improving faculty confidence 32% and reducing support requests 18%.
- Designed HPU's first cross-disciplinary Pathway system using e-portfolios and achievement badges, giving leadership new visibility into student progression, informed by ongoing adoption and engagement data analysis.

UNC GREENSBORO | Greensboro, NC

Program Manager, K-5 Engineering Education

August 2015 – December 2017

- Directed multi-stakeholder implementation of the Engineering is Elementary curriculum across schools, coaching teachers and adapting programming for diverse learning contexts.
- Designed and facilitated STEM-focused professional development for dozens of educators district-wide.
- Developed quantitative, qualitative, and mixed-methods evaluation instruments to assess program success and inform district strategy.

Instructional Designer and Project Manager

September 2013 – July 2015

- Project-managed cross-functional online course development teams (faculty, multimedia developers, designers) on Canvas and WordPress, ensuring milestones, accessibility standards, and institutional alignment.
- Designed and launched UNCG's first MOOC, a high-visibility initiative that expanded the university's digital presence and set the stage for future online programs.

AWARDS AND HONORS

- **Coursera Vision & Values Award (2025):** Team honored for principled innovation, platform leadership, and AI-integrated teaching tools.
- **Duke Presidential Award (2021):** Recognized for extraordinary contributions in transitioning Duke to remote teaching during COVID-19.

PUBLICATIONS

Book Chapters

Jones, M.G. & Leagon, M.R. (2014). Science teacher attitudes and beliefs: Reforming practice. In N. Lederman & S. Abell (Eds.), *Handbook of Research on Science Teaching* (pp. 830–847). Routledge, NY.

Articles in Peer-Reviewed Journals

Carlone, H.B. & Lancaster, M.R. (2024). "Getting along" and "using evidence": Elementary engineering as contentious practice. *Journal of Research in Science Teaching*.

Lancaster, M.R. (2016, July). Engineering technology for the digital world. *Science Scope*, 39(9).

Lancaster, M.R. & Jones, M.G. (2015, July). Science meets engineering: Applying the design process to monitor leatherback turtle hatchlings. *Science Scope*, 38(9), 53–62.

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Lancaster, M.R., Rogers, H. (2024, July). Designing with Empathy: Integrating Trauma-Informed Principles in Asynchronous MOOCs. Conversations with Colleagues presentation, UPCEA Distance Teaching & Learning, Minneapolis, MN.

Lancaster, M.R., Hudson, M. (2022, May). Accelerate Skill Development with Coursera Labs. Technical presentation, Coursera Conference, Virtual.

Carlone, H.B., Lancaster, M.R. (2018, March). Productive friction and 'getting along' in an elementary engineering classroom. NARST Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Project Management Professional (PMP) Certification, Project Management Institute
- M.S. Science Education, North Carolina State University
- M.S. Engineering Physics, Appalachian State University
- B.S. Physics, University of North Carolina at Greensboro